

Acme Corp — IT Procurement Policy

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1. Purpose & Scope

This document establishes the official policies, standards, and procedural requirements for the procurement of all Information Technology (IT) assets, software, hardware, cloud-based services, and related technical consulting services across Acme Corp. The objective of this policy is to optimize IT expenditures, ensure rigorous data security and regulatory compliance, minimize technical debt, and guarantee compatibility with the existing corporate enterprise architecture.

Scope: This policy applies to all departments, business units, subsidiaries, employees, and third-party contractors acting on behalf of Acme Corp. It covers any purchase, subscription, lease, or acquisition of technology assets, regardless of funding source or cost center.

2. Core Procurement Principles

- **Centralized Governance:** All technology purchases must be reviewed and approved by the IT Department prior to commitments or fund transfers. "Shadow IT" (unauthorized software or hardware acquisition) is strictly prohibited.
- **Security by Design:** No software or service that handles, processes, or stores Acme Corp or customer data may be procured without undergoing an Information Security Risk Assessment.
- **Fiscal Responsibility:** Standard competitive bidding protocols must be observed to maximize return on investment (ROI) and minimize total cost of ownership (TCO).
- **Lifecycle Management:** Procurement evaluations must account for the full lifecycle of the asset, including deployment, maintenance, compliance, and decommissioning or disposal.

Important Compliance Directive: Failure to adhere to the IT Procurement Policy may result in the immediate revocation of access to the unapproved software/hardware, rejection of expense reimbursement requests, and formal disciplinary review.

3. Procurement Thresholds & Approval Workflows

The matrix below outlines the mandatory sourcing paths and authorization levels based on the total contract value (TCV) or total transaction cost:

Purchase Threshold (TCV)	Sourcing Requirements	Required Reviewers	Final Approver
Under \$5,000	Direct Purchase via Approved Catalog	IT Infrastructure Team	Department Head
\$5,000 – \$50,000	Minimum 2 Written Quotes	IT Infrastructure & InfoSec	Director of IT
\$50,001 – \$250,000	Formal Request for Proposal (RFP)	IT Board, InfoSec, Legal	VP of Technology / CIO
Over \$250,000	Comprehensive RFP & Board Review	IT, InfoSec, Legal, Procurement	Chief Financial Officer & CIO

4. Vendor Selection & Due Diligence

Before entering into formal negotiations or executing contracts with technology vendors, the following due diligence standards must be executed:

4.1 Architecture and Compatibility Assessment

The IT Architecture Board must evaluate the proposed solution to ensure seamless integration with current core systems. Precedence must always be given to standard enterprise solutions already deployed within Acme Corp (e.g., existing SaaS suites) before introducing novel platforms.

4.2 Information Security & Privacy Evaluation

Any solution involving cloud hosting (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS) or data processing must provide contemporary compliance documentation, including but not limited to:

- SOC 2 Type II Certification (issued within the last 12 months)
- Detailed Data Processing Addendum (DPA) aligning with GDPR/CCPA regulations
- Vulnerability assessment and recent third-party penetration testing summaries
- Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery (BC/DR) plans

5. Software Lifecycles & Licensing

To prevent license non-compliance and avoid legal liabilities, all software assets must be actively tracked via the corporate IT Asset Management (ITAM) platform. Free, open-source, or freemium software intended for commercial use must follow standard IT review protocols to ensure licensing terms do not introduce intellectual property or compliance risks.

6. Hardware Standardization Policy

To reduce operational maintenance overhead, Acme Corp maintains a strict hardware catalog. Standard workstation profiles (Laptops, Desktops, Monitors, and Accessories) are refreshed every three (3) to four (4) years. Standard configurations are pre-approved for immediate fulfillment when headcount budget approvals are confirmed. Requests for custom or non-standard hardware configurations require explicit justification and authorization from the Director of IT Infrastructure.

7. Policy Exceptions

In the event of an emergency requirement (e.g., critical system failure or immediate security mitigation threat), a temporary exception may be authorized by the CIO. All emergency procurements must be documented and undergo retroactive standard compliance and legal review within fifteen (15) business days of execution.